

Akinwale Oladimeji

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EDUCATION

PhD, School of Earth, Environment, and Sustainability

University of Iowa | 2024 – Present

MSc, Biological Sciences

University of Cape Town | 2021 – 2023

BSc, Wildlife Management

Federal University of Agriculture, Abeokuta (FUNAAB) | 2013 – 2019

AWARDS AND GRANTS

2025	University of Iowa Graduate Engagement Corps (GEC) Grant Program (\$2,000)
2025	MasterCard Foundation FAST Program (\$5,000)
2021-2023	MasterCard Foundation Scholarship Award to pursue graduate research and studies at University of Cape Town (~\$50,000)
2023	Yale School of Environment, Yale University Award to present my MSc thesis at International Congress for Conservation Biology (ICCB) conference in Kigali, Rwanda (\$2603.93)
2023	International Congress for Conservation Biology (ICCB) Travel Award to present my MSc thesis at 2023 ICCB conference in Kigali, Rwanda (\$700)
2022	UCT Research Fund. Thesis Research: How land–use influences wildlife occupancy and species richness in Cape Town, South Africa (\$3000)
2022	IDEA WILD equipment grants to support my MSc thesis research (\$1000)
2019	Abeokuta Bird Club Research grant. Project Research: Factors influencing abundance and species richness of birds in Olusegun Obasanjo Presidential Library Complex, Abeokuta, Nigeria (\$500)
2018	Organization President of the Year, Forestry and Wildlife Student’s Association

WORK EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant – Contemporary Environmental Issues (SEES 1070), Introduction to Sustainability (SEES 2013) and The Global Environment (SEES 1020)

University of Iowa | 2024 – Present

- Organize course materials, assignments, and student records using structured systems (e.g., Canvas and spreadsheets)
- Track deadlines and ensure students clearly understand submission timelines
- Provide step-by-step guidance to students with different learning styles, adjusting explanations to meet individual needs
- Review and grade student work carefully, ensuring consistency and accuracy in feedback
- Support communication between instructor and students, including updates on student progress
- Introduce key environmental issue concepts, guide in-class activities through discussion and feedback

Lead Instructor – Contemporary Environmental Issues (SEES 1070)

University of Iowa | 2025 Summer

- Designed and delivered course content, including lectures, assignments, and assessments
- Led classroom sessions and facilitated discussions on environmental and geographic topics
- Managed course logistics, including scheduling, grading, and student communication
- Created an inclusive learning environment that encouraged student participation and engagement

Wildlife Manager

Olusegun Obasanjo Presidential Library Wildlife Park | 2019 – 2020

- Maintained and recorded information on animal populations and park activities
- Prepared written and verbal reports for management based on observations and data collected
- Supervised interns and coordinated daily activities, ensuring tasks were completed on schedule
- Communicated information clearly to visitors and staff through guided tours and education sessions

Researcher/Admin

Yisau Environmental Research Team, Nigeria (Part-time) | 2016–2019

- Monitored the research timeline and ensure work is completed on schedule
- Ensured research information is easily accessible
- Prepared adequate reports for projects
- Assisted with wildlife extension work on local residents within and around protected area (Old Oyo National Park) in Nigeria

COMMUNITY SERVICES AND LEADERSHIP ROLES

Vice Chairperson and Career Representative

Mastercard Foundation Scholar Council, University of Cape Town | 2022 – 2023

- Coordinated a structured welcome program for incoming scholars across multiple countries
- Managed event logistics including scheduling, communication, and coordination with university offices
- Ensured smooth execution of multi-day academic and social programs
- Managed the council's career social media platform to share job opportunities, internships, and career events
- Attended Council and Committee meetings on a regular basis
- Acted as an ambassador for the council, promoting its activities in the wider community
- Represented scholars in career-related matters within and outside the university
- Fostered partnerships and alumni connections
- Organized career-oriented events

Member, Girl Child Education Drive Nigeria | 2014–2024

- Offered mentorship services to girl child
- Contributed towards indigent female student's educational materials (books) to stimulate easy learning

Field researcher, Nigeria South-West Atlas Team | 2018-2021

- Conducted field work on bird species for the research organization
- Assisted with spatial analyses of bird distribution using GIS tool

President, Forestry and Wildlife Student's Association, FUNAAB | 2018-2019

- Upheld the core values of The Students' Union and be an ambassador for the Students' Union
- Raised ~\$500 through fund-raising to support our community project
- Supported activities such as Open Days, Freshers', and official students' union events
- Ensured student ideas are taken forward and actioned wherever possible.
- Met regularly with key stakeholders from the University and local community
- Conducted free extra classes to student that were struggling with their grades

Orientation Leader, New Student Program, FUNAAB | 2016-2019

- Interacted with over 100 students and their families during orientation sessions
- Completed intensive 3-week training to gain expertise.
- Facilitated cultural learning sessions to foreign exchange students to enhance their cultural adjustment.
- Assisted students and parents with check-in and new orientation processes.
- Lead a Group of 20 freshmen that were unclear about "campus life".
- Toured students around campus and explore the library, cafe, admission office, gym, and many more classroom and facilities

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Data Analysis: R, GIS (ArcGIS, QGIS), spatial analysis
- Visualization: Tableau, data dashboards, mapping
- Programming: Python (GeoPandas, spatial processing)
- Productivity & Communication: Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Oladimeji, A. R., Woodgate, Z., & O’Riain, M. J. (2024). Wildlife resilience in an urban landscape: understanding land-use impacts in Cape Town. *Urban Ecosystems*, 27(6), 25172530. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11252-024-01606-1>

Yisau, M. A., Akintunde, O. A., Ijose, O. A., Sanni, T. O., Osunsina, I. O. O., & **Oladimeji, A. R.** (2023). Assessment of External and Internal Quality Traits of Eggs of Wild Doublespurred Francolinus *Pternistic bicalcaratus* sourced from three States in Nigeria. *European Journal of Zoology*, 2(1), 1–5. <https://doi.org/10.24018/ejzoo.2023.2.1.21>

Yisau M. A., Akintunde O. A., **Oladimeji A. R.**, Osunsina I. O. O., & Adebisi T. T. (2023). ASSESSMENT OF HUNTERS’ HARVESTED ANIMALS IN TWO BUSH MEAT MARKETS. *FUDMA JOURNAL OF SCIENCES*, 7(2), 96–99. <https://doi.org/10.33003/fjs2023-0702-1715>.

CONTRIBUTED PRESENTATIONS (AS PRESENTING AUTHOR)

2023 International Congress for Conservation Biology, Kigali, Rwanda

2025 International Urban Wildlife Conference, Atlanta Georgia

ATTENDED CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS

- 2025 Iowa Chapter of The Wildlife Society Winter Meeting, held at the Quality Inn and Suites in Ames, IA
- 2022 Workshop on R studio, Organised by the Department of Biological Sciences, University of Cape Town
- 2019 Training on Excel and R for data analysis, organized by the Achievers Group, held at Federal University of Agriculture, Abeokuta.
- 2019 World Migratory Bird Day (WMBD) “Protect Birds: Be the Solution to Plastic Pollution”. Abeokuta Bird Club.
- 2018 International Conference on Sustaining Forests towards Achieving Global Goals: Roles of African Youths organized by International Forestry Students Association (IFSA), held at University of Ilorin, Kwara State, Nigeria.
- 2019 2nd Commonwealth Forestry Association (CFA) Conference on ‘Collaboration of Stakeholders for Dynamic Restoration of Forest Estate in Nigeria’. Organized by Commonwealth Forestry Association, Nigeria Chapter.
- 2017 4th Commonwealth Forestry Association (CFA) Workshop on ‘Forestry and Health Care Delivery in the Tropics’. Organized by Commonwealth Forestry Association, Nigeria Chapter.